

July 26, 2026

Hiring Committee — Office of the Inspector General

City of New York

New York, NY

Re: Inspector General

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Inspector General position. I began my career as a **bank examiner with the Florida Office of Financial Regulation**, examining banks alongside federal banking regulators and conducting safety-and-soundness examinations and authoring the workpapers that supported formal enforcement actions. I have spent the twenty years since on the other side of that table — inside a global institution, building the evidence that regulators either accept or reject. Both halves of an Inspector General's job are work I have already done.

Independent examination, and findings that survive challenge. At Citi I led risk-based thematic examinations across 15+ business units and drove **consent-order remediation** — authoring the issue-closure packages and remediation evidence submitted to quality assurance and external regulators. Consent-order work is unforgiving: an institution under a federal order has every incentive to declare itself fixed, and the examiner's job is to determine whether the evidence actually supports that claim. I learned to write findings that hold up when the subject of the finding is powerful and motivated to disagree.

Root cause, not just exception. I investigated control failures through to root cause across legal-entity divestitures and cross-enterprise change programs, then escalated to senior leadership and the Board Audit Committee. The discipline that matters is the same one an IG needs: separating what went wrong from who is blamed, documenting it so it withstands scrutiny, and reporting it to people who did not want to hear it.

Oversight of automated decision-making — the coming IG problem. I authored an AI governance framework referencing NIST AI RMF and SR 11-7, covering model inventory, explainability, and human-in-the-loop controls, and I built the underlying technology myself. My doctoral work at FIU centres on bias in professional judgment: I completed an IRB-approved empirical study in July 2026, and my dissertation in development extends it to **automation bias** — when professionals defer to a system because it sounded confident. City agencies are adopting automated tools for benefits screening, enforcement targeting, and case triage. Oversight of those systems requires someone who can read the model documentation and the audit trail, not only the policy memo. That capability is rare in this field right now, and I have it.

An honest framing. My examination career is financial regulation, not municipal government. I have not administered New York City Charter authority, and I would be learning the jurisdictional boundaries, referral relationships with the Department of Investigation, and the specific statutory framework rather than arriving fluent in them. What transfers is the core of the work: independence, evidence standards, investigative persistence, and the judgment to know when a finding is strong enough to publish.

I am a Newark resident, in the New York metro, and I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role.

Sincerely,

Yasir A. Malik

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